

What's going on, everyone?!

COLLEGE FOOTBALL IS BACK!

How was everyone's first full weekend of the season? LSU beat the ever-loving hell outta Clemson, Oregon spent most of the afternoon playing with its food before escaping Boise State, Ole Miss/Louisville delivered the banger we were promised, and Michigan needed replay to find one last second in the couch cushions before throwing a Hail Mary to avoid losing to Western Michigan.

Tulsa beat Oklahoma State AGAIN, which is an incredible start to the Eric Morris era if your goal is to immediately make every Oklahoma State fan miserable. Houston took care of Oregon State behind a pretty solid Conner Weigman performance, Notre Dame eventually remembered it was playing Wisconsin, Ohio State and Texas spent the weekend stat padding before playing each other, and the Aggies beat Missouri State 50-0 in a game that was extremely important and meaningful and everyone should care about.

Anyways, how did the actually important competition shake out?

DARIO IS OUR WEEK 1 LEADER!

And honestly, it wasn't particularly close. Malachi Toney caught 234 yards and THREE touchdowns against Stanford for a ridiculous -368 points. Throw in Conner Weigman's 305 passing yards with a touchdown through the air and another on the ground, plus Rasheem Biles getting five tackles and an interception, and Dario finishes Week 1 at -36 points. Starting the year with a negative total is pretty disgusting.

Sam comes in second with 66 points. Trinidad Chambliss threw for 336 yards and three touchdowns while adding another on the ground for -76 points, and Jadan Baugh went for 160 rushing yards and THREE touchdowns against FAU for -220. That is an absurd quarterback/running back combo. Ian Strong and Sammy Brown did their best to bring the score back toward normal, but the damage was already done.

Marc starts the year in third with 217 points, led by Jeremiah Smith doing exactly what everyone expected him to do against Ball State: 151 receiving yards and two touchdowns in basically one half of football. Rocco Becht's four touchdowns against Marshall also helped, and Sammy Brown chipped in ten tackles. Hollywood Smothers wasn't too shabby either. Really solid week across the board, which is disappointing because I was hoping to make fun of at least one of these picks.

Hollie comes in right behind him at 230 points after picking Arch Manning despite our household's long-standing belief that Arch is Booty Butt. Unfortunately, he was very much NOT Booty Butt against Texas State, throwing for 305 yards and four touchdowns for -25 points. She also got in on the Jadan Baugh action for -220. Duce Robinson and Gideon Lampron tried their best to ruin things, but that's still a really good first week.

Chris finished with 352 points, which feels almost impossible considering Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa recorded ZERO defensive stats (he didn't play) and handed him the full 400. Julian Sayin threw for 320

yards, three touchdowns, and ran for another to get him -60, while Jadan Baugh added another -220. Two incredible picks and then a defensive player who needs to toughen up.

Jackson lands at 421, led by Kamari Moulton running for 183 yards and two touchdowns for -166 points. Conner Weigman was also a great pick for 15 points. Unfortunately, Jayce Brown had 14 receiving yards against Clemson, which is not exactly the kind of number we're looking for here. Still, one huge pick can carry a LOT of nonsense in this game.

Brian is right behind him with 459 points. Julian Sayin got him -60, Makhi Hughes had a nice game against Oregon State, and Ryan Williams caught 130 yards against ECU. Jaxton Eck's five tackles weren't ideal, but there's really nothing too terrible here. Just a solid, boring Week 1. Sorry, Brian.

Logan finished with 509, and I'm a little surprised the total wasn't better after Dante Moore threw for 378 yards and three touchdowns against Boise State. Unfortunately, Mario Craver only had 41 receiving yards against Missouri State—which feels personally offensive to me—and Tony Rojas finished with seven tackles against Marshall. Bo Jackson had 83 yards and a touchdown, which was fine, but we are looking for greatness here!

Spencer checks in at 593 points. Wayne Knight was easily his best pick after running for 71 yards and THREE touchdowns against Cal for -42 points. CJ Carr was pretty solid against Wisconsin, but Trey'Dez Green only had 58 yards in LSU's demolition of Clemson. How does your team score 51 points and your giant alien tight end doesn't get a touchdown? Suntarine Perkins added six tackles, so overall this was just kind of a perfectly average Stat Game week.

Mike G. finished with 636 points despite having Ryan Wingo go for 121 yards and a touchdown against Texas State. Jaron-Keawe Sagapolutele—I'm sure I'll learn how to spell that without looking sometime around Week 12—was a pretty good quarterback pick, and Bo Jackson was fine. But Na'eem Offord recorded ONE tackle against Iowa, which got Mike a lovely 375 points. That'll do it.

And then there's **me**.

I finished Week 1 with 927 points, which is dead last among people who made picks (I can't recall specifically, but this *might* be the first time ever I've been in last place at any point during this competition). Not one negative score. Not even particularly close! Drew Mestemaker was fine. Wyatt Young was fine. Ray Coney had six tackles. Antwan Raymond had 42 rushing yards against UMass. Just an absolutely disgusting collection of mediocrity. Great work by me. No notes.

Lastly, **Mike M., Ian, Chapa,** and **Jonathan** did not make picks this week. You can ABSOLUTELY still play and catch up. It's Week 1, and considering I just scored 927 points, nobody is out of anything. Just let me know if you aren't planning to play this year so I'm not spending the next month wondering if you forgot, the app broke, or you're simply giving the rest of us a head start.

As always, let me know if you have any issues with the app or submitting your picks. I'm not in IT, but I can at least attempt to help.

Good luck this week, and don't forget to submit your picks!

When we settle exactly who is playing, I'll send out the latest payout chart.

















